

Demidius Thorne

Level 17-25 Optimization and Advancement Guide



Probability. Magical supremacy. Leadership. Divine ascent.

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Demidius should remain a Charisma-first Spirit Guide Oracle whose best combat contribution is removing enemy magic, protecting the party's action economy, and turning one successful dispel into a full-party opening. He should not spend scarce feats or godly powers trying to compete with the party's damage specialists.

The immediate order is:

1. Preserve Mythic Greater Dispel Magic and Spell Perfection (greater dispel magic).
2. Fill any missing pieces of the dispel chain: Dispel Synergy, its mythic version, and reliable initiative.
3. Reach Oracle 18 for 9th-level spells.
4. Obtain wandering weather and secure a GM ruling for its effect on the Dawnrigger.
5. Confirm whether Evangelist's Aligned Class advances Oracle beyond 20 before entering the prestige class.
6. Use the first inexpensive campaign-Boon mythic-feat purchases on Dispel Synergy (Mythic) and Improved Initiative (Mythic), if their prerequisites are met.
7. After the cheap mythic-feat purchases, save toward Mortal God unless a Suzerain-template upgrade produces a clearly more urgent campaign-scale benefit.

Confirmed starting point

Category	Confirmed state at level 17
Class	Oracle 17, Spirit Guide archetype
Mystery	Later, enchantment-oriented Juju mystery
Mythic	Mythic rank/tier 7 in the current project record
Divine identity	Demigod of Aphrodite; worshiper and Blessed of Hermes
Godly powers	Four: two Aphrodite Charisma increases and two Suzerain enhancements
Template	Suzerain, enhanced through divine powers
Core roles	Face, buffer, controller, dispeller, probability manipulator, leader
Campaign spell rule	May cast wizard spells as divine spells
Core mythic spell	Mythic Greater Dispel Magic
Legendary item	Eyebrow Piercing of Confidence

The current sheet is not fully reproduced in the project. Every recommendation below uses an ordered queue: if Demidius already owns an option, advance to the next missing item rather than duplicating it.

Recommended class progression

Primary track - if Evangelist is approved before level 20

Character level	Class level	Effective Oracle level	Main gain and action
17	Oracle 17	17	Current state. Audit feats, revelations, mythic abilities, and spells known.
18	Oracle 18	18	Gain 9th-level Oracle spell access. Lock miracle as the first broad answer unless already covered.
19	Evangelist 1	18	Pay the one-level Aligned Class delay only after 9th-level spells are secured. Confirm Hermes obedience package first.
20	Evangelist 2	19	Aligned Class resumes Oracle advancement. Confirm how epic spell slots will work before proceeding.
21	Evangelist 3	20	Reach effective Oracle 20 and the final revelation if Aligned Class advances it. Evangelist boon milestone is redundant if the custom Hermes package already grants the same benefit.
22	Evangelist 4	21	Continue only if the GM has defined Oracle 21+ advancement.
23	Evangelist 5	22	Continue the Oracle engine through Aligned Class.
24	Evangelist 6	23	Second Evangelist boon milestone; choose a nonduplicative Hermes benefit.
25	Evangelist 7	24	Continue effective Oracle progression and prepare for Evangelist 9 at level 27.

This is the best thematic track only if the GM confirms all four points: Evangelist is legal in epic play, Aligned Class advances Oracle after 20, the level-19 delay does not block the epic spell table, and the custom Hermes obedience has nonduplicative boons.

Safe fallback track

Take Oracle 18, Oracle 19, and Oracle 20 at character levels 18-20. This preserves the published Oracle endpoint without interpretation. At level 21, enter a full-casting epic or prestige progression only after the table defines level 10 and 11 spell slots. Exalted is the strongest divine-obedience theme; Loremaster is the cleanest neutral full-casting chassis; Harrower is the most thematic luck chassis. None automatically creates epic spell slots.

Standard feat plan

Retraining order

Apply these only if the named feat is still present and no current story arc needs it.

Priority	Retrain	Replace with	Reason
1	Deceitful	Dispel Synergy	Converts a successful dispel into a saving-throw opening.
2	Conceal Spell	Improved Initiative	Acting before the enemy caster is worth more than routine concealment.
3	Divine Fighting Technique	Destructive Dispel	The rapier is a backup; the stun/sicken rider supports the real combat engine.
4	Diverse Obedience	Inexplicable Luck or Divine Interference	Retrain only if the custom Hermes system fully replaces its unique boon access.

New feat slot queue

Demidius receives ordinary character feats at levels 19, 21, 23, and 25. At each slot, take the first legal missing option in this order.

1. Dispel Synergy.
2. Improved Initiative.
3. Destructive Dispel.
4. Divine Interference - expend a divine spell to force an enemy to reroll a successful attack against an ally.
5. Inexplicable Luck - prerequisite for the excellent mythic version.
6. Persistent Spell - strongest general save-pressure metamagic when immunity has already been removed.
7. Piercing Spell - conditional third-party prerequisite for its mythic version when spell resistance is a recurring obstacle.
8. Augment Teleportation - conditional Super Genius Games option for fleet and extraction logistics after GM approval.

Do not spend a new feat on weapon damage. Do not retrain Spell Perfection, its metamagic prerequisites, Fate's Favored, Strange Revelation, or any feat the current dispel equation actually uses.

Mythic path ability order

First audit the sheet for Inspired Spell, Eldritch Breach, Divine Metamastery, Enduring Blessing, and Flexible Counterspell. Fill missing core abilities before adding luxuries.

Priority	Mythic path ability	Function
1	Inspired Spell	Cast any eligible divine-list spell without knowing or preparing it; the campaign's wizard-as-divine ruling may make this enormous.
2	Eldritch Breach	Roll twice on caster-level checks to dispel, penetrate spell resistance, or determine whether magic affects a target.
3	Divine Metamastery	Apply key metamagic without slot or casting-time increase; build toward Quicken.
4	Enduring Blessing	Convert important long buffs into 24-hour effects. A second selection at tier 6 reaches shorter buffs.
5	Make Your Own Luck	Legendary Games option that converts a competence, insight, or morale bonus into luck for the campaign's Fate's Favored interaction.
6	Contingency Plan	Mythic Minis option for action-efficient contingency access and emergency planning.
7	Flexible Counterspell	Immediate-action answer when Mythic Greater Dispel is unavailable or conservation matters.
8	High Clerist	Tier-6 strategic choice for Leadership, Mythic Leadership, religious construction, and follower operations.
9	Spontaneous Lifegiver	Adds flexible mythic healing when Amparo cannot cover the emergency.

Cross-path and third-party selections require the campaign's normal approval route. High Clerist is strategically exceptional, but it should not displace the core casting engine before tier 6.

Mythic feat order

Mythic feats contribute one Mythic Power point under the campaign rule. When campaign Boons buy mythic feats, apply the escalating purchase cost based on the number already purchased with Boons.

Priority	Mythic feat	Prerequisite/check	Why now
1	Dispel Synergy (Mythic)	Base Dispel Synergy	Extends the saving-throw penalty to allies and makes the dispel a party-wide setup.
2	Improved Initiative (Mythic)	Improved Initiative	Strongest universal way to act before hostile casters and establish tempo.
3	Extra Mythic Power	None beyond mythic status	Fuels Inspired Spell, Amazing Initiative, counterspells, and emergency rerolls.
4	Inexplicable Luck (Mythic)	Inexplicable Luck	Large emergency d20 bonus; reserve it for encounter-defining rolls.
5	Still Spell (Mythic)	Still Spell	Casting insurance while grappled, injured, moving, or fighting on a storm-tossed deck.
6	Destructive Dispel (Mythic)	Destructive Dispel	Improves the rider after reliability is already solved.
7	Spell Focus (Mythic) - Enchantment	Spell Focus (enchantment)	Roll-twice save pressure after mind-affecting immunity is removed.
8	Mythic Spell Lore	Mythic spellcasting eligibility	Expand the mythic spell portfolio when path slots are tighter than feat slots.

Deific Obedience - Hermes

Deific Obedience boons are not the campaign's spendable Boons, and neither system replaces the trials that made Demidius Blessed of Hermes.

The best documented Hermes package adapts printed same-tier boons under the lesser/custom deity guidance in Inner Sea Gods:

Boon tier	Recommended Hermes boon	Printed model	Advice
1	Divine Favor, 3/day	Chaldira, Exalted 1	The ordinary luck bonus becomes unusually efficient under Fortune's Child and Fate's Favored.
2	Fortune's Child	Chaldira, Sentinel 2	Increases every luck bonus Demidius receives and stacks with Fate's Favored under the campaign ruling.
3	Seven-Pipped Gem	Nivi Rhombodazzle, Exalted 3	Immediate-action bonus after rolling but before learning the result; confirmed as part of Demidius's current engine.

Because Demidius already has Seven-Pipped Gem, the GM should decide whether the current custom Hermes gifts count as the full Deific Obedience package. Do not take a feat or prestige level to buy the same boon twice.

If a nonduplicative boon is available, preferred substitutions are Familiar Journey for extraction, Infectious Joy for enchantment DCs, Paralyzing Song for encounter control, or Blast of Motes for party support. Each substitution must remain within the same or lower boon tier.

Spendable campaign Boons

Use this order unless a story event changes the goal.

1. Buy Dispel Synergy (Mythic) if its current Boon cost is one or two and the base feat is complete.
2. Buy Improved Initiative (Mythic) as the second inexpensive mythic-feat purchase if legal.
3. Confirm the exact tier of the Suzerain template. If a three- or five-Boon upgrade materially expands the 250-recipient organization, compare it against the Mortal God fund.
4. Save 10 Boons to advance from demigod to Mortal God. This is the default long-term target because a divine-rank increase affects multiple campaign systems.
5. Bank a small reserve for a god save, divine negotiation, or emergency favor during the Culling.

Do not buy adoption without clarifying whether it would alter the existing Aphrodite ancestry or Hermes patron relationship. Do not spend expensive late mythic-feat purchases on small numerical bonuses when the Mortal God threshold is within reach.

Nonmythic spell acquisition order

Immediate - levels 17-18

1. Wandering weather - highest-priority fleet spell; its center follows the caster. Obtain a GM ruling for the actual Dawnrigger speed calculation.
2. Greater dispel magic - keep known and ready as the signature spell.
3. Blessing of fervor - premier party action, mobility, and defense buff.
4. Death ward and freedom of movement - prevent common high-level shutdowns.
5. Greater heroism - long-duration competence support for a key ally.
6. Contingency - emergency extraction, survival, or anti-control trigger.
7. Forcecage - no-save battlefield partition after the opening dispel.
8. Mind blank - essential defense and the protection Demidius must expect to remove from enemies.
9. Moment of prescience - decisive insight bonus when Seven-Pipped Gem must be conserved.

First 9th-level spells

1. Miracle - broadest emergency and campaign-scale answer.
2. Overwhelming presence - mass encounter control after mental defenses fall.
3. Gate - planar access and extraction; calling uses remain dangerous and expensive.
4. Time stop - preparation and tempo, not direct offense.
5. Mage's disjunction - reserve for situations where collateral damage is acceptable.
6. True resurrection - only after a trapped soul has been released.

Strategic and infrastructure additions

- Permanency and mythic permanency for protected infrastructure.
- Forbiddance and dimensional lock for the demiplane, temples, and secure rooms.
- Greater teleport and teleportation circle for fleet and organization logistics.
- Discern location, commune, legend lore, and contact other plane for intelligence.
- Mage's magnificent mansion for expedition support.
- Billow the sail only after the GM approves Frog God Games material and the workbook multiplication order.
- Calculated luck before a planned sequence of caster-level checks; Seven-Pipped Gem remains better for one pivotal check.

Mythic spell acquisition order

The exact number known depends on current path abilities and Mythic Spell Lore. Fill the first missing entry.

Priority	Mythic spell	Primary use
1	Greater Dispel Magic	Roll-twice reliability, mythic-effect rerolls, automatic nonmythic counterspelling, and immediate-action augment.

Priority	Mythic spell	Primary use
2	Blessing of Fervor	Party-wide tempo and flexibility.
3	Permanency	Protect permanent infrastructure from nonmythic dispelling and disjunction.
4	Mind Blank	High-level mental and divination defense.
5	Forcecage	Durable no-save battlefield control.
6	Moment of Prescience	Decisive check, save, or defense.
7	Overwhelming Presence	Mass control after immunity-granting magic is stripped.
8	Freedom	Answer imprisonment and related permanent incapacitation.
9	Teleport or Greater Teleport	Safer group movement and extraction.
10	Gate	Planar operations and recovery missions.

Mythic resurrection and true resurrection do not retrieve an imprisoned soul. Aristeia must be extracted from Tartarus first.

Epic spell priorities

These are campaign spells, not automatic rewards for reaching level 21. Use them only after the GM defines access, slots, learning, and preparation.

First level-10 divine choices

1. Perfect Resurrection - best restoration after soul recovery.
2. Epic Heal - encounter-scale recovery.
3. Cloak of the Gods - long-duration damage reduction.
4. Master Mending - fleet and infrastructure repair.
5. Enchant Item - permanent asset creation.

First level-11 divine choices

1. Epic Dispel Magic - natural extension of the build; verify its full check mechanics before selection.
2. Perfect Restoration - campaign-grade condition and ability repair.
3. Healing Aura - sustained party support.
4. Armor of the Mass - long-duration group defense, subject to the campaign luck-stacking ledger.
5. Epic Particulate Form - defense and mobility.
6. Mass Dominate Monster - only if the crossed-out arcane entry and divine-list inclusion are confirmed by the GM.

Level-by-level action plan

Level	Mandatory action	First missing feat/power	Spell priority
17	Audit sheet and obedience duplication	Dispel Synergy / Mythic Dispel Synergy	Wandering weather; contingency
18	Oracle 18	Complete initiative and dispel chain	Miracle; mind blank; moment of prescience
19	Evangelist 1 if approved; otherwise Oracle 19	Divine Interference or Inexplicable Luck	Forcecage; greater teleport
20	Evangelist 2 or Oracle 20	Mythic initiative / Extra Mythic Power	Overwhelming presence; gate
21	Effective Oracle 20 or first epic class	Persistent Spell or Piercing Spell	Permanency infrastructure package
22	Confirm epic Oracle advancement	Make Your Own Luck / Contingency Plan	Discern location; planar security
23	Continue approved epic chassis	Next missing standard feat	Expanded mythic spell portfolio
24	Evangelist boon milestone if applicable	High Clerist at tier 6+	Fleet and organization spells
25	Effective Oracle 24 or approved equivalent	Final missing reliability feat	Prepare for level-10/11 spell access

Combat doctrine

1. Before the fight, identify enemy protections and activate long-duration defenses.
2. Win initiative; do not spend Seven-Pipped Gem on a low-impact roll.
3. Open with targeted Mythic Greater Dispel Magic against mind blank, freedom of movement, spell turning, death ward, contingencies, and escape effects.
4. Apply Dispel Synergy and let the party exploit the saving-throw penalty.
5. Use no-save force control when immunity remains; use enchantment only after mental defenses are actually removed.
6. Keep an immediate action for counterspelling or emergency protection.
7. Use Amazing Initiative or other extra actions only when the extra spell changes the encounter.

GM decisions required

- Does Inspired Spell treat every wizard spell as eligible under the wizard-as-divine rule?
- Does Inspired Spell's caster-level increase apply to the dispel check?
- How do Eldritch Breach and the Legendary mythic dispel roll-twice clauses combine?
- Does Evangelist's Aligned Class advance Oracle beyond 20?
- What epic spell-slot table applies at levels 21-25?
- Do existing custom Hermes gifts satisfy Deific Obedience boons, or are they separate?
- What is the present Suzerain template tier?
- How does wandering weather modify the Dawnrigger's speed?

Sources

- Pathfinder Roleplaying Game: Mythic Adventures, especially pp. 5-19, 32-37, 50-77, and 169-173.

- Inner Sea Gods, Gozreh and deity-boon models pp. 68-75; prestige classes pp. 198-203; obedience feats pp. 204-217.
- Ultimate Wilderness, PDF p. 238 / printed p. 237, wandering weather.
- Mythic Spell Compendium, Greater Dispel Magic PDF pp. 75-76 and relevant spell entries.
- Mythic Hero's Handbook, High Clerist p. 23; Make Your Own Luck p. 30; Destructive Dispel p. 145; Dispel Synergy p. 148; Inexplicable Luck p. 186.
- Mythic Minis 10, 12, 16, 18, 51, and 60, relevant rules on PDF pp. 2-3.
- Inner Sea Gods lesser/custom deity adaptation guidance as recorded in the campaign-setting content review.
- Epic Spell Compendium, campaign transcription and reconstruction.
- Demidius project Campaign Rules, Mechanical Reference, Optimization Codex v1.5, and Mythic Spell Compendium sweep.